



The Six-Semester Cheatsheet for BCA students

Everything your syllabus will not tell you to do — four tracks, six semesters, and a set of honest yes-or-no questions to check yourself against twice a year.

Prepared for the BCA orientation — Lachoo Memorial College of Science & Technology, Jodhpur

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Tick honestly. A box you cannot tick is information, not failure.

THE WHOLE THING ON ONE PAGE

Four tracks, six semesters

Competence alone is not enough. Each track buys you something the others cannot.

	YOU	TEAM	INDUSTRY	ECOSYSTEM
Sem 1	Build the habit of making things	Notice who actually shows up	Find out what a job really is	Learn what support exists
Sem 2	Ship something. Be findable.	First team of two or three	Watch how real work is discussed	Get on the register
Sem 3	Taste three domains	Real roles, real deadline	Get inside something real	Enter one competition
Sem 4	PICK YOUR DOMAIN	Someone pays — even ₹500	The internship, and the vocabulary	Walk into the incubator
Sem 5	Go deep. Get proof.	Run it like a company	Depth, and a real reference	Pitch to a stranger
Sem 6	Convert	Decide honestly	Ask for referrals	Know your second route

You gets you competent. **Team** gets you employable. **Industry** gets you chosen. **Ecosystem** gets you help you did not know was free.

Miss any one of the four and you will spend your final year wondering why people with lower marks got better offers.

शरीरमाद्यं
खलु धर्मसाधनम्

“The body is the first instrument of duty.” — Kālidāsa, Kumārasambhava 5.33, and the motto of AIIMS.

A fifth line runs along the bottom of every semester page: **You · Body & Mind**. It is part of the You track, not a separate one — because none of the other three survive without it, and it is the one thing on this sheet you cannot catch up on later.

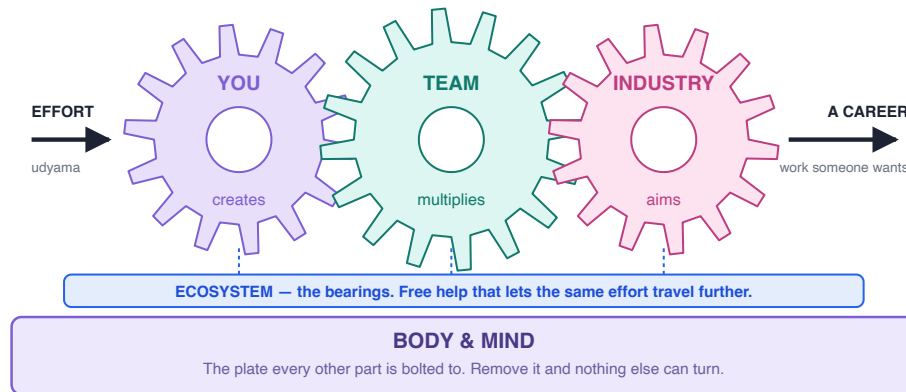
HOW TO USE THIS

- Open it **twice a semester** — once in the first week to plan, once in the last week to score yourself.
- Tick only what is **actually true**. A certificate of participation is not a tick.
- **Attending is not exposure**. A webinar, a seminar, a factory tour — none of it counts. It counts when somebody was depending on you to finish something.
- An untickable box in Sem 2 is fine. The same box untickable in Sem 5 is the whole problem.
- **Not everyone will build products**. If your route is enterprise platform work — ServiceNow, SAP, Salesforce and the like — there is a page for that immediately after Semester Four.
- **Semester 4 is the decision semester**. Everything before it is exploration; everything after it is depth. Do not arrive there undecided.

HOW THE FIVE FIT TOGETHER

It is one machine, not five lists

Only one part actually creates anything. The others multiply it, aim it, or let it travel further — and one of them is not a track at all, it is the ground.



YOU	<i>creates</i>	The only part that generates anything. Until this turns, the rest of the machine has nothing to work with — which is why the first three semesters are about building, not choosing.
TEAM	<i>multiplies</i>	Cannot create power — only multiply what You produces. Which is why a team never rescues someone with nothing to contribute.
INDUSTRY	<i>aims</i>	Decides where the power goes. Skip it and you spin fast in the wrong direction — and find out in your final year.
ECOSYSTEM	<i>reduces friction</i>	Free space, mentors, competitions, platforms. Adds no power of its own; lets the same effort travel much further. Cheapest part, most ignored.
BODY & MIND	<i>carries</i>	Everything above is bolted to it — and it is the only part you cannot rebuild later.

This is a **product**, not a **sum**. A zero anywhere makes the whole answer zero — and a ten somewhere else cannot rescue it.

संगच्छध्वं संवदध्वं सं वो मनांसि जानताम्।

“Move together. Speak together. Let your minds be of one accord.” Parts that do not turn together are not a machine — they are a pile of parts.

Rgveda 10.191.2 — from the Sāṅgaṭhana Sūkta, the closing hymn of the Rgveda.

उद्यमेन हि सिध्यन्ति कार्याणि न मनोरथैः।

न हि सुप्तस्य सिंहस्य प्रविशन्ति मुखे मृगाः।।

“Work is accomplished by effort, not by wishing. Deer do not walk into the mouth of a sleeping lion.” — Hitopadeśa. That is the crank on the left of the picture: nothing here turns on its own.

BEFORE YOU START — READ THIS ONCE

Your relationship with AI

You will use it every day of your career. Almost nobody will teach you how. Four rules.

1 Never submit what you do not understand.

Not to a teacher, not to a client, not to a manager. The moment you hand over work you cannot explain, you have stopped being the engineer and become the courier.

2 Ask it to teach before you ask it to do.

“Explain why this works” builds you. “Write this for me” builds nothing. Write some of it yourself, every time — especially when you are tired and it would be easier not to.

3 Verify anything that matters.

It is confident when it is wrong, and that is the whole danger. Learn to spot **where** it goes wrong in your subject — that skill is rarer, and worth more, than the ability to prompt it.

4 Spend the time it saves on harder problems.

If AI saves you four hours and you do nothing with them, you have not gained four hours. You have simply become four hours less practised than the person who did.

AI should **increase the difficulty of the problems you attempt** — not reduce the amount you think.

By your final semester, you should be able to answer one question without hesitating: **what can I do with these tools that another graduate cannot?** If the honest answer is “nothing”, the tools are not the problem.

SEMESTER ONE

Do not choose. Explore.

You cannot pick between options you have never tried. This semester buys you options.

THE ONE THING

Build the habit of making things.

YOU

- ☐ A GitHub account with at least **one thing pushed** to it
- ☐ A professional email address — my actual name, not a nickname
- ☐ I have built **one small thing that runs**, however ugly
- ☐ I have read someone else's code and understood part of it
- ☐ I keep a **build log** — what I made, what broke

TEAM

- ☐ I know who in my batch actually **finishes** what they start
- ☐ I have worked with at least **3 different people** on something small
- ☐ I have noticed who is good at things that are **not coding** — talking, drawing, organising

INDUSTRY

- ☐ A real conversation with **one working person** about what their day actually looks like — not their job title
- ☐ I know the difference between a service company, a product company and a startup
- ☐ I follow 5 people who do the work I might want to do

ECOSYSTEM

- ☐ I know that **TiE University** and **iStart Rajasthan** exist, and roughly what each does
- ☐ I have found out whether my college has an E-Cell or a Launchpad

YOU · BODY & MIND

Sleep. Everything else is built on it.

- ☐ **7 hours, most nights.** The all-nighter is not a badge — it is borrowed time at a very high interest rate
- ☐ I eat breakfast
- ☐ One physical activity I actually enjoy, twice a week

HONEST SELF-TEST

Can I show someone **one thing I made** this semester?

Do not do yet: pick a domain, buy a course, or worry about placements.

SEMESTER TWO

Ship something. Become findable.

Work nobody can see does not exist. This semester you leave a trace.

THE ONE THING

One stranger uses something you built.

YOU

- ☐ One project is live and **5 people who are not my friends** have used it
- ☐ My **LinkedIn profile is complete** — real photo, clear headline, an About section I wrote myself
- ☐ I can use Git without copying commands blindly
- ☐ I have written one short public post explaining something I learned
- ☐ I know one senior I can ask questions

TEAM

- ☐ First team of 2–3 formed, and we **shipped one thing**
- ☐ One shared repo and we did not lose anyone's work
- ☐ At least one of us is **not primarily a coder**
- ☐ One disagreement resolved without anyone walking out

INDUSTRY

- ☐ I read one industry newsletter or publication weekly
- ☐ I have read **10 real job descriptions** for roles I might want in 3 years
- ☐ One meetup or event attended — **and I spoke to a stranger**

ECOSYSTEM

- ☐ I know **3 organisations** that support student entrepreneurs and what each actually does
- ☐ I have registered on the **iStart Rajasthan** portal

YOU · BODY & MIND

Move daily. Fix your desk before it breaks you.

- ☐ **30 minutes of movement, every day**
- ☐ 20–20–20 for the eyes: every 20 minutes, look 20 feet away, for 20 seconds
- ☐ Screen at eye level, chair supports my back — **backs, wrists and eyes end programming careers**

HONEST SELF-TEST

*If someone searched my name today, would they find **anything I made?***

Coordinating a team of three is harder than coding alone. That is the lesson, not a complaint.

SEMESTER THREE

Taste three domains.

Find out what you do not hate. That is a more reliable signal than what excites you in a video.

THE ONE THING

One small project each in three different domains.

YOU

- ☐ One project each in **three different domains** — health, money, agriculture, local business, education
- ☐ I know **SQL properly** — not “I did it in class”, properly
- ☐ I have worked with other people on one codebase
- ☐ Applied to at least **5 internships**, even if I got nothing back
- ☐ On LinkedIn I now **comment thoughtfully**. I do not have to post yet.

TEAM

- ☐ Team of 4–5 with **named roles**: Builder / Seller / Maker of Sense / Organiser
- ☐ We built something for a **real outside user** — a local shop, a society, an NGO
- ☐ We entered one hackathon or competition, whatever the result
- ☐ Someone owns “talking to the user” — and it is **not** the best coder

INDUSTRY

- ☐ Real work for someone outside college. Unpaid is fine. **A tour does not count.**
- ☐ **10 cold messages** sent offering to help — and I have been ignored by most
- ☐ I have seen how one real business operates: where the money comes from, what breaks

ECOSYSTEM

- ☐ Entered **TiE University** (the college programme — not TYE, which is for schools) or an iStart challenge
- ☐ Attended one event at an incubator or startup body **and spoke to a stranger**

YOU · BODY & MIND

Build a base while it is cheap to build.

- ☐ Strength or stamina work, **3 times a week**
- ☐ Water — not only tea, coffee and energy drinks
- ☐ One real meal a day that did not come out of a packet
- ☐ No habit forming that I would have to hide from my family

HONEST SELF-TEST

Which of the three did I keep opening at 1 a.m.? — and did my team **deliver on the date we promised?**

Being ignored by nine out of ten people you approach is the normal rate, not a verdict on you.

SEMESTER FOUR · THE DECISION SEMESTER

Pick your domain. One.

Pharma. Fintech. Security. Energy. Manufacturing. One. Depth needs two full years — which is exactly what you have left.

THE ONE THING

Choose your domain and write down why.

YOU

- ☐ Domain chosen, and the reason written down — one paragraph, dated
- ☐ One internship done — paid, unpaid, remote, local, any
- ☐ I follow the domain's news weekly
- ☐ I know **20 terms** an outsider would not
- ☐ Portfolio site live, 3 projects, what each one does
- ☐ Resume v1 exists and **a working person has torn it apart**

TEAM

- ☐ Someone outside our friend circle **paid us money** — any amount
- ☐ We know what our thing costs to run per month
- ☐ One person **owns the money** and can state the number
- ☐ We have talked to **20 potential users** and written down what they said

INDUSTRY

- ☐ I know what my domain's customers actually complain about
- ☐ I have seen how work is assigned and reviewed inside a company
- ☐ I could hold a 5-minute conversation in my industry **without being spotted as a student**
- ☐ I have found **where my domain actually talks** — a forum, community, association, Slack or Discord — and I read it weekly

ECOSYSTEM

- ☐ I have used the **iStart Nest in Jodhpur** at least once — free co-working, meeting rooms, local legal and accounting advice
- ☐ I know what support a registered startup can actually claim

YOU · BODY & MIND

Keep the routine when it gets busy. That is the whole skill.

- ☐ **My routine survived my busiest month** — that is the test, not how it looks in a calm week
- ☐ I stop working at a fixed time at least 5 nights a week
- ☐ I have one thing I do regularly that involves **no screen**

HONEST SELF-TEST

Can I explain to a stranger **what problem my domain has and why it is hard**? If not, I have picked a label, not a domain.

The first rupee from a stranger is the moment it stops being a college project.

A SECOND ROUTE — IT OPENS AT SEMESTER FOUR

If you are not going to build products

Most of you will not start a company or ship your own product. That is not the lesser path — on this route the pay is often better and the queue is far shorter.

Every large company in the world runs on platforms that somebody has to configure, extend, integrate and support — service management, customer systems, finance, supply chain. That work is unglamorous, permanently in demand, and almost nobody in your batch is competing for it. It is the same bet that built India's IT industry: **take the work everyone else finds boring.**

WHERE TO START — THE VENDORS' OWN FREE ROUTES

ServiceNow	Workflows and service management inside large enterprises. Register on the Developer Program for a free personal developer instance , train on Now Learning, and aim at CSA as the entry certification.
Salesforce	Customer, sales and service systems. Trailhead is free , with a Playground org to practise in. The Associate credential is the entry point designed for newcomers.
SAP	Finance, supply chain and manufacturing — the largest enterprise market of the lot. Self-study material exists, but real hands-on access usually comes through an employer or partner. Check what you are getting before you pay for anything.
Others	Pega, Workday, Oracle, Microsoft Dynamics. Same pattern every time: free or cheap learning, a sandbox to practise in, and one entry certification that gets you interviews.

SEM 4

Choose your route as well as your domain.

If it is a platform: pick **one**. Not three. Create the free account, get the sandbox, and finish the first learning path end to end.

SEM 5

Pass the entry certification — then go past it.

A certificate alone is common. Build something real on the platform — a working configuration or app someone uses — not tutorial exercises. Intern or shadow at an implementation partner.

SEM 6

Apply to implementation partners directly.

They hire steadily, they hire in volume, and they often hire outside campus placement entirely. Most of your batch will never contact one.

One warning. There is a large industry of paid institutes promising platform training and guaranteed placement. The vendors' own routes above are free or nearly free — start there, and only pay for something once you know exactly what it adds. Verify current programme and certification details on the vendor's own site before you spend money: they change.

Team, Industry and Ecosystem do not change on this route. You still need a team, still need to get inside real work, still need the free help nobody uses. The only column that changes is **You**.

SEMESTER FIVE

Go deep. Get proof.

Depth is the one thing nobody can copy quickly. Everything else can now be generated in seconds.

THE ONE THING

One substantial project that solves a real problem for a real person.

YOU

- ☐ One project solves an actual problem **for someone I do not know**
- ☐ Every certification I hold is **domain-relevant** — not a random collection
- ☐ **3 mock interviews** done, and I was embarrassed by all of them
- ☐ I post on LinkedIn monthly about what I am building — not motivational quotes
- ☐ I have written one piece long enough to be **useful to a stranger** — a proper write-up, not a post

TEAM

- ☐ A weekly rhythm we have **actually kept for 3 months**
- ☐ One owns the customer, one owns the product
- ☐ We **survived a serious conflict** without the team dissolving
- ☐ Something we made is used by someone we have **never met**
- ☐ We have written down what we would do differently
- ☐ One real user has said something good about what we built, **in their own words, that we did not write for them**

INDUSTRY

- ☐ Second attachment, or the first one extended
- ☐ Something I built or fixed is **running in production**
- ☐ **One working professional would take my call** and speak well of me
- ☐ I have spoken to 10 people working in my domain
- ☐ I have posted something useful **there**, not only on LinkedIn — and someone replied

ECOSYSTEM

- ☐ I have **pitched to someone who is not a teacher and not a friend**
- ☐ I have one mentor from outside my college
- ☐ If real outsiders use what we built, it is **listed where buyers actually look** — G2, Capterra, Trustpilot or the app stores. Creating the listing is free.

YOU · BODY & MIND

Mind. This is the year it gets tested.

- ☐ I can name the **signs of burnout** in myself
- ☐ I have a limit on scrolling, and I keep it
- ☐ I have talked to someone when I felt low — friend, family, or a counsellor. **Asking is not weakness**
- ☐ I do not measure myself against my batchmates' offers every single day

HONEST SELF-TEST

*Does **anyone in my chosen industry** know my name yet? Even one person?*

A reference who is not a teacher and not a relative is worth more than any certificate you will collect.

SEMESTER SIX

Convert.

Three years of proof, turned into a door. And a second door, in case the first one does not open.

THE ONE THING

Turn proof into an offer — and have a backup route.

YOU

- ☐ Applying **on campus and off campus in parallel**
- ☐ Portfolio and resume reflect **my domain**, not a scatter of everything
- ☐ Decided: job / higher study / build — **and I have a backup**
- ☐ I have thanked the people who helped me over three years

TEAM

- ☐ Decided: continue / park it / close it — and **said it out loud**
- ☐ If closing: users told, money settled, parted cleanly
- ☐ Each of us can describe our own contribution in **60 seconds**
- ☐ We stayed friends

INDUSTRY

- ☐ I have asked at least **3 people for a referral** — referrals beat applications
- ☐ My work is visible to people in my industry, not just my batch
- ☐ I know the real entry-level job titles in my domain, and their real salary range
- ☐ I have **referred or recommended someone else** — referrals come back to people who give them first

ECOSYSTEM

- ☐ I know my route to a job that **does not run through campus placement**
- ☐ We have reviews from users we did **not** recruit — and we never asked a friend to write one. **Solicited reviews get products delisted**, and everyone can tell.

YOU · BODY & MIND

Leave with a rhythm you can still keep at thirty.

- ☐ One basic health check done — free camps count
- ☐ I know what sitting at a desk all day will do to me, and what I will do about it
- ☐ The habits I am leaving college with are ones I could keep for ten years

HONEST SELF-TEST

*If campus placement gave me **nothing**, do I have a second route? If no — build it this semester, not in May.*

Closing a team properly is a skill most working adults never learn. Doing it well counts as a win.

WARNING SIGNS & WHERE TO GET HELP

Check yourself against these

Not once at the end. Twice a semester, honestly.

RED FLAGS — AT ANY SEMESTER

- I have watched more tutorials than I have built projects
- My GitHub has forks and clones, nothing of my own
- I am “learning” five things and have finished none
- My LinkedIn has connections but no evidence of work
- I talk about my startup but cannot build or sell anything
- I have **never once been rejected** — which means I have never applied

IF YOU REMEMBER ONLY THREE THINGS

- 1 **Build something every semester.** Six things in three years beats a 9.0 CGPA with nothing to show.
- 2 **Pick a domain by semester 4.** Depth needs two years. You cannot decide in the final year.
- 3 **Be findable.** If you cannot be found, you can only be selected — never sought.

WHERE TO GET HELP — MOST OF IT FREE, MOST OF IT UNUSED

TiE University	The college-level programme of The Indus Entrepreneurs — startup challenge across 300+ colleges in 25+ countries. Nearest chapter: TiE Jaipur . <i>Note: TYE is the school programme, Grades 9–12 — not this one.</i>
iStart Rajasthan	The state government's startup platform. Register on the portal. Runs a School & Institute programme that places “Launchpad” mini-incubators inside colleges.
iStart Nest, Jodhpur	A physical incubation centre in this city — free co-working space, connectivity, meeting rooms, local legal and accounting counselling.
Startup India	Central government recognition, and the benefits that follow it, once you have something real.
Your own college	E-Cell, project cell, alumni network, and any faculty member who has worked in industry. Ask. Most of them are waiting to be asked.

Programme details for government and network schemes change. Confirm the current position with iStart or your college coordinator before you rely on it — which is itself the habit this sheet is trying to teach you.

IF YOU REMEMBER NOTHING ELSE

Anyone can generate an answer. Become the person who can tell whether it is right.

Three years from now, do not leave Lachoo with only a BCA degree.
Leave with six semesters of evidence.



SCAN TO FOLLOW ON LINKEDIN

STAY CONNECTED

LinkedIn linkedin.com/in/jatindhoot

Instagram instagram.com/jatin.dhoot

Facebook facebook.com/jatindhoot

I do not have jobs to hand out. I have time, occasionally, for people who have actually made something.
